

Service That Works

We spoke with manufacturers about their service networks in an attempt to correlate their service scores with what they do on the ground. Companies with well-trained call centre personnel were appreciated by consumers, and Samsung even managed an upset in the service score for hard disk drives solely on the basis of their customer support staff being liked better.

Common sense would say that the closer the service centre is to the customer, the better the service would be. That is generally true.

All vendors have a central clearing house for service that, at the minimum, handles the database and has a major repair centre. For companies such as Zenith, no hardware repair is done anywhere else. Retailers may only attempt to fix software issues. So whether the problem has a 15-minute resolution time or requires chip-level repair, it must be shipped to Navi Mumbai. Most retailers choose to use cheaper, slower methods resulting in long wait times for the owner—on an average, 22 days.

Rashi Peripherals, on the other hand, leverages their 28 service centres in India to better effect, resolving simpler problems in their regional centres closest to the customer. This results in Sony optical disk drives being serviced in 11 days on the average.

The 'Icons of Trust' survey interviews were conducted online (through thinkdigit.com) and telephonically. The research sample was taken from the existing reader base of *Digit*, where

2,123 respondents were interviewed. Respondents shared their experiences with about 5.4 products on an average. To maintain a homogenous mix of respondents, people from over

100 cities were chosen to get experiences over the entire geography of India.

Readers were invited to offer their feedback through two means: by replying to an insert in *Digit* magazine, or by responding to an e-mail request to take the survey. Both methods were tagged with a unique numerical identifier. A respondent would log on to the survey page using this number, and once logged off, the identifier would expire. This ensured that

The Repurchase Index

Throughout this survey, an important factor, the Repurchase Index, has been put forth for all manufacturers in all categories.

This Index tells us how many existing users of a particular brand would buy from the vendor again. This is a percentage of the users we polled for the survey.



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